

Psychology in Outline

on the Basis of Experience

Psykologi i Omrids paa Grundlag af Erfaring

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Harald Høffding

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Chapter 1

The Subject Matter and Method of Psychology

Chapter 2

Soul and Body

Chapter 3

The Conscious and the Unconscious

Chapter 4

Classification of the Psychological Elements

Chapter 5

The Psychology of Cognition

5.1 Sensation

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Chapter 6

The Psychology of Feeling

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Chapter 7

The Psychology of Will

7.1 The Originality of Will

7.2 Will and the Other Elements of Consciousness

7.2.1 The Higher Development of Will, Conditioned by the Development of Cognition and Feeling

When the momentary impulses rule, there is properly no inner center, no self in consciousness. But the more memory and the ruling feelings determined by it assert themselves, the more does the human being's whole nature, not merely a single, momentarily predominant side of it, gain influence over action. The human being's true self has its expression in the thoughts and feelings that in the course of life have taken deepest root in him. (Cf. V B, 5). And only when action has come to be determined by this firm core can the human being be said to have willed his action, to have determined himself. Will is to that extent determined by the ruling passion as the expression of the result that the human being's development has deposited up to the moment of action. Now it is the elements of cognition, now the elements of feeling, that predominate, so that one can distinguish between a thought-will and a feeling-will. We must here remember that it is not always the most vehement feeling of the moment that is in reality the strongest—that is, that has the deepest root in the individual's nature. All the more important is it that the moment should not be the sole determining factor; therefore the formation of the aforementioned interval is so important. It is filled by deliberation, the inner debate in consciousness, in which all representations and feelings psychologically possible for the individual can speak a word. Through this debate the mere resolve becomes decision,

and a choice is made among the possibilities that present themselves. The dice are cast.

This is the highest form of willing. It is predominantly determined from within, not by the single sensation. Drive knows only one possibility, one motive; genuine will unfolds itself through the interaction or struggle of several motives and possibilities. It is often determined by something that lies far beyond the moment, indeed beyond the individual's entire reality, but which nonetheless asserts itself in the individual's consciousness, is represented within it. The psychological understanding of the willed action depends on whether it is possible to trace the individual's course of development and follow it step by step to the moment of action, each individual transition being explained according to the general psychological laws. This is of course an ideal; but it indicates the principle and the presupposition of all psychological inquiry and of all practical dealings among human beings.

7.2.2 The Counter-Effect of Will on Cognition and Feeling

7.2.3 The Relation of Opposition between Will and the Other Elements of Consciousness (Concentration and Expansion)

7.2.4 The Consciousness of Will

7.2.5 Will and the Unconscious Life of the Soul

7.3 The Individual Character